



AI SEO Mastery Pro [Start ...

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Getting Started



SEO Foundation



Setting Up Your AI



Local SEO Foundations



Overview

GBP Audit

GBP Landing Page Audit

GBP Management Set Up

How to Do Local AI SEO



Client Deliverables Walkthro...

3 Phases of Local SEO

Local Link Overview

Identifying Low Competition

Estimate Scope of Work

[Tool] Scope Based Pricing

What is the Core 30?



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Before diving into the Core 30 concept, it's crucial to understand a fundamental principle of local SEO that sets it apart from traditional SEO strategies. In local SEO, **every single piece of content on your website exists for one primary purpose—to rank your Google Business Profile (GBP) higher.**

This represents a significant shift in mindset from traditional SEO. While conventional SEO often focuses on ranking individual pages for specific keywords, local SEO takes a holistic approach. Every URL, every article, every page on your site works together as part of a larger ecosystem designed to establish your business as the go-to authority in your local area.

💡 **Key Insight:** In local SEO, we're not trying to rank individual articles or pages. Everything we create is designed to build topical or geographical relevance that elevates your GBP in local search results. This unified



Onboarding Clients

Rank Tracking

The Power of Topical Relevance

[Determining Local Rank Ma...](#)[Adding Schema](#)[What is the Core 30?](#)[How to Structure the Core 30](#)[Core 30 Content Audit](#)[Example Site for Core 30](#)[Structure for Multiple Locati...](#)[Building More Topical Relev...](#)[Building More Geographical ...](#)[AI Content Prioritization - G...](#)[Creating an "About" Page](#)[Local Business Schema](#)[Technical Audit](#)[Reduce Client Churn](#)[60 Day Internal Task Tracker](#)[The Google Business Pr...](#) ▼[Creating AI Content](#) ▼[Building a Core 30 Web...](#) ^[Overview](#)

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[Prompt 1: Skeleton](#)[Prompt 2: GBP Landing Pag...](#)

Building a successful local SEO presence follows a specific hierarchy that cannot be shortcuts. You must establish topical relevance before geographical relevance—this is non-negotiable. Think of it as building a house: you need a solid foundation before you can add walls and a roof.

Why Topical Relevance Comes First

Consider this practical example: You can't establish yourself as "Chicago's best plumber" if Google doesn't first understand that you're a plumber. Without strong topical signals, any geographical signals you send become meaningless. It's like trying to be famous for something you haven't proven you can do.

The most effective way to build this topical relevance is through strategic content creation that mirrors your business's actual services and expertise. This is where the Core 30 strategy becomes not just useful, but essential to your local SEO success.



Related Learning: To understand how Google evaluates topical relevance and authority, review the lesson [How SEO Authority is Passed](#) in the SEO Foundation module.

What Exactly is the Core 30?

The Core 30 is a strategic content framework that creates perfect alignment between your website structure and your Google Business Profile. It's called the "Core" 30 because these pages form the absolute foundation of your local SEO presence—without them, other efforts will yield limited results.

Core Components Breakdown

1. Category Pages (3-5 pages)

- These are your broadest service offerings (e.g., "Plumbing Services," "HVAC Services")
- Each page should contain 1,500-2,500 words of in-depth content

Prompt 3: GBP Landing Pag...

Prompt 4: Secondary Categ...

Prompt 5: Core Service Pag...

Prompt 6: Service Page Buil...

Prompt 7: About and Conta...

Prompt 8: Technical SEO Im...

Walkthrough of Caleb's Build

Starting Off-Site AI SEO ^

Introduction to Backlinking

External Anchor Text Guideli...

Local Authority Building

Searching for Link Opportun...

Monthly Google News Featu...

Blog Commenting

Social Signals

Optimizing for AI Syste... v

Special Circumstances ^

YMYL-Niche Sites

Ethics: E-E-A-T Authorship ...



How often attributes on links

Hiding Content from Users

Disavowing Existing Backlin...

- Focus on explaining what the category encompasses and why it matters

2. Service Pages (20-30 pages)

- One detailed page for each specific service listed in your GBP
- These drill down into specific offerings (e.g., "Water Heater Repair," "Drain Cleaning")
- Each page should contain 1,000-2,000 words of targeted content
- Include specific information about processes, benefits, and common customer questions

3. Essential Business Pages

- **About Us:** Establishes your business story, credentials, and local connection
- **Contact Us:** Provides clear pathways for customer engagement
- Additional pages as needed (e.g., service areas, testimonials)

This typically totals around 30-40 pages—hence the name "Core 30" (because, let's be honest, "Core 40" doesn't have the same ring to it!).



Strategic Note: The exact number isn't as important as the concept. Whether you end up with 28 or 35 pages, what matters is that you have comprehensive coverage of every service and category in your GBP.

Why the Core 30 Works So Effectively

The Core 30 strategy succeeds because it leverages multiple

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1. Content Volume and Depth

When properly executed, the Core 30 creates tens of thousands of words of topically relevant content. This massive content foundation sends strong signals to Google about your expertise

Non-Local SEO ^

Non-Local SEO Engagement...

Basic Site Structure

Search Console for Existing ...

Click Through Rate (CTR) A...

Identify Content with Existin...

Generate Topical Relevance

Keyword Research Philosop...

AI-Generate Keyword Variati...

Creating a Content Planner

AI-Rewriting Pages

and comprehensive service offerings. It's not just about quantity —it's about creating a complete topical map of your business.

2. Perfect Structural Alignment

Your website structure becomes a mirror image of your GBP structure. This alignment makes it incredibly easy for Google to understand:

- What services you offer
- How those services relate to each other
- Which services are most important to your business
- How comprehensive your expertise is in each area

3. Internal Linking Opportunities

With 30+ interconnected pages, you create natural opportunities for internal linking that:

- Distributes authority throughout your site
- Helps users navigate between related services
- Reinforces topical relationships
- Keeps visitors engaged longer

4. User Experience Benefits

Visitors can easily find detailed information about any service they're interested in, improving:

- Time on site metrics
- Conversion rates
- Customer confidence
- Overall user satisfaction



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Creating AI Content module.

Monitoring Your Progress: The Data-Driven Approach

Building the Core 30 isn't a "set it and forget it" strategy. Success requires careful monitoring and adjustment based on real performance data.

Setting Up Your Tracking System

1. Implement Rank Tracking

- Use professional rank tracking tools to monitor local visibility
- Track rankings for your primary service + location combinations
- Monitor both GBP rankings and organic website rankings
- Set up alerts for significant ranking changes

2. Automate Rank Maps

- Schedule weekly or bi-weekly rank map reports
- These visual representations show your visibility radius
- Watch how your coverage area expands as you publish content
- Identify gaps in coverage that need attention

3. Track Publishing Impact

- Document when each Core 30 page goes live
- Note ranking changes 2-4 weeks after publishing
- Identify which pages create the biggest impact
- Use this data to prioritize remaining content



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achieve their ranking goals before even completing all 30 pages! Many businesses see significant improvements after publishing just 10-15 pages, especially if they start with their most important categories and services.

Critical Success Factor: Link Building

While creating the Core 30 content is crucial, remember that content alone isn't enough in competitive markets. The two-pronged approach of content + links is what creates unstoppable local SEO momentum.

Why Links Matter for the Core 30

- **Authority Distribution:** Links pass authority to your Core 30 pages, making them more likely to influence your GBP rankings
- **Crawl Priority:** Linked pages get crawled and indexed faster
- **Trust Signals:** Quality links indicate that other websites vouch for your content
- **Competitive Edge:** In competitive markets, links often make the difference between ranking #3 and ranking #1

Link Building Best Practices for Core 30

1. Prioritize Your Most Important Pages

- Start with category pages (they're broader and easier to link to)
- Focus on your highest-revenue services
- Build links gradually and naturally

2. Diversify Your Link Sources

- Local business directories
- Industry-specific directories
- Local news and blog mentions

- Community organization sites

3. Monitor Link Impact

- Track which pages have links



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- Measure ranking improvements after link acquisition
- Adjust strategy based on results

 **Next Steps:** Learn more about effective link building strategies in the module **Starting Off-Site AI SEO**, particularly the lessons on [Introduction to Backlinking](#) and [Local Authority Building](#).

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

Understanding what not to do is just as important as knowing what to do:

1. Publishing Without Optimization

Don't just create content for the sake of hitting a number. Each page should be:

- Fully optimized for its target service/category
- Written with user intent in mind
- Properly formatted with headers, bullets, and images
- Mobile-friendly and fast-loading

2. Ignoring Content Quality

AI can help create content quickly, but don't sacrifice quality for speed:

- Always edit AI-generated content
- Add local examples and case studies
- Include unique insights from your business experience
- Ensure accuracy and helpfulness



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While the Core 30 is designed to rank your GBP, remember that real people will read these pages:

- Write in a conversational, approachable tone
- Answer common customer questions

- Include clear calls-to-action
- Make it easy to contact you



Content Tip: Review [Human Editing of AI Articles](#) in the Creating AI Content module to ensure your Core 30 pages resonate with real customers.

Putting It All Together: Your Action Plan

Audit Your Current State

Quality matters more than quantity. Thirty mediocre pages won't outperform fifteen excellent ones that truly serve your customers' needs. The good news is that 80% of businesses achieve their ranking goals before completing all 30 pages—the strategy is that powerful when executed properly.

- List all categories in your GBP
- List all services in your GBP
- Identify which pages already exist on your website
- Create a gap analysis

Prioritize Your Content Creation

Remember that topical relevance must come first—you simply cannot build geographical relevance without establishing what your business does. Monitor your progress continuously with rank tracking tools to guide your efforts and ensure you're moving in the right direction. The combination of quality content and strategic link building creates the momentum you need for lasting success.



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- Fill in remaining service pages
- Add any missing essential pages

Create a Publishing Schedule

The Core 30 represents the foundation of local SEO success. Without it, other efforts will have limited impact because you lack the topical relevance necessary to compete effectively. Creating perfect alignment between your website structure and GBP sends powerful relevance signals that Google cannot ignore.

- Aim for 2-3 new pages per week
- Allow time for proper optimization
- Build in link acquisition for each page
- Monitor results continuously

Measure and Adjust

Remember that topical relevance must come first—you simply cannot build geographical relevance without establishing what your business does. Monitor your progress continuously with rank tracking tools to guide your efforts and ensure you're moving in the right direction. The combination of quality content and strategic link building creates the momentum you need for lasting success.

- Track ranking improvements weekly
- Identify which pages drive the most impact
- Adjust your strategy based on data
- Celebrate wins along the way

Resources



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